Northstar Solutions — Employee Handbook (Sample Dataset)

Fictional company document for RAG practice. All policies and figures are invented.

1. Working hours

The standard workday is 9:30 a.m. to 6:00 p.m., Monday through Friday. Employees should take a 45-minute lunch break. Teams may agree to flexible start times between 8:30 a.m. and 10:30 a.m., provided their manager approves the arrangement.

2. Remote work

Employees may work remotely up to two days per week after completing their first 30 days. Remote days must be recorded in the team calendar by Friday of the preceding week. Roles involving physical equipment or confidential paper records may have different requirements.

3. Annual leave

Full-time employees receive 18 days of paid annual leave per calendar year. Leave requests of one or two days should normally be submitted at least three working days in advance. Requests for five or more consecutive working days should be submitted at least 15 calendar days in advance.

4. Sick leave

Employees receive 8 paid sick days per calendar year. If an employee is absent for more than two consecutive working days, the manager may request a medical certificate. Unused sick leave does not carry over to the next calendar year.

5. Public holidays

The company observes 10 paid public holidays each year. The HR team publishes the holiday calendar in December for the following year. If a public holiday falls on a weekend, HR will communicate whether a substitute day applies.

6. Learning budget

Each full-time employee may claim up to ■15,000 per financial year for approved job-related courses, books, or certification exams. Approval must be obtained from the manager before purchase. Reimbursement requests must include receipts and proof of completion.

7. Expense reimbursement

Business travel expenses must be submitted within 30 days of the trip. Meal reimbursement is capped at ■800 per day during domestic travel. Taxi fares are reimbursable when public transport is impractical or when travel occurs before 6:00 a.m. or after 9:00 p.m.

8. Equipment

Employees receive a company laptop and security key where required by their role. Lost equipment must be reported to IT and the manager within four hours of discovery. Employees should not store company confidential files in personal cloud accounts.

9. Performance reviews

Formal performance reviews occur twice per year, in April and October. Employees complete a self-review first, followed by a manager review and a development discussion. Promotion decisions are separate from the review meeting and depend on role scope, sustained performance, and available positions.

10. Support contacts

For payroll questions, contact payroll@northstar.example. For laptop or account issues, contact it-help@northstar.example. For leave, benefits, or policy questions, contact people-team@northstar.example. These example addresses are fictional.